RESULTS

Division I

TEAM SCORES: 1, Lakewood St. Edward 111.5. 2, Massillon Perry 91. 3, Brecksville-Broad. Hts. 84. 4, Cle. St. Ignatius 76.5. 5, Wadsworth 74. **6 (tie), Elyria, Mayfield Vill. Mayfield 49.** 8, Twinsburg 46. 9, Cin. Moeller 42. 10, Marysville 39.

(Local)

19 (tie), Westlake 22. 53 (tie), Olmsted Falls 8. 64 (tie), Southview 3. 72 (tie), Berea 2.

CHAMPIONSHIP FINALS

103: Kory Mines, Maple Hts. dec. Brian Hauser, Lyndhurst Brush 4-1;
112: Jerome Robinson, Cle. St. Ignatius dec. Gus Sako, Lakewood St. Edward 4-2sv;
119: Jamie Clark, Lakewood St. Edward maj. dec. David Bolger, Strongsville 12-4;
125: Sam White, Massillon Perry dec. Nick Lawrence, Westlake 3-2;
130: Shawn Fayette, Miamisburg dec. Ty Davis, W. Chester Lakota West 9-4;
135: Robert Shepherd, Mason dec. John Gallagher, Cin. St. Xavier 7-5;
140: Collin Palmer, Lakewood St. Edward dec. Tommy Sasfy, Reynoldsburg 3-1;
145: David Habat, Cle. St. Ignatius dec. T.J. Rigel, New Carlisle Tecumseh 4-3;
152: Josh Demas, Westerville North dec. Nick Sulzer, Lakewood St. Edward 4-3;
160: Kyle Lang, Brecksville-Broad. Hts. pin J.T. Rice, Hilliard Davidson 3:04;
171: Nick Heflin, Massillon Perry dec. Cory Hayes, Mayfield Vill. Mayfield 3-1;
189: Andrew Tumlin, Harrison dec. Mike Lanigan, Brecksville-Broad. Hts. 5-3sv;
215: Orlando Scales, Cin. Elder pin Denicos Allen, Hamilton 3:26;
285: Jeremy Johnson, Brecksville-Broad. Hts. dec. James Meder, Parma Hts. Valley Forg 5-1

THIRD-PLACE FINALS

(Local wrestlers)

130: Dalton McHenry, Elyria dec. Zach Dailey, Massillon Perry 13-6;
135: Anthony Salupo, Lakewood St. Edward (Westlake) dec. Scott Mattingly, Uniontown Lake 4-2.

FIFTH-PLACE FINALS

(Local wrestlers)

152: Joe Crabtree, Hilliard Darby pin Phillip Egnor, Elyria 4:59;
160: Zack Goins, Elyria over Caleb Marsh, Marysville default;
215: Kyle Rose, Centerville over Ryan Nelisse, Elyria default;
285: Sean Brooks, Clayton Northmont dec. Zach Laird, Olmsted Falls 3-1.

CONSOLATION SEMIFINALS

(Local wrestlers)

130: Zach Dailey, Massillon Perry dec. Charlie Packard, Brecksville-Broad. Hts. 4-2; Dalton McHenry, Elyria dec. Ryan Hoyt, Cle. St. Ignatius 8-2;
135: Scott Mattingly, Uniontown Lake dec. Mike Hillock, Massillon Perry 3-0; Anthony Salupo, Lakewood St. Edward dec. Joe Parra, Barberton 8-1;
152: Andrew Gasber, Madison dec. Phillip Egnor, Elyria 4-2; Aron Brenner, Canfield dec. Joe Crabtree, Hilliard Darby 5-2;
160: Darren Rhodes, Macedonia Nordonia dec. Zack Goins, Elyria 5-3; Tylan Coleman, Mayfield Vill. Mayfield over Caleb Marsh, Marysville default;
215: Nick Tavanello, Wadsworth over Ryan Nelisse, Elyria default ; Nate Weeks, Marysville dec. Kyle Rose, Centerville 6-4sv;
285: Ben Buzzelli, Wadsworth dec. Zach Laird, Olmsted Falls 1-0; Adam Walls, Beavercreek dec. Sean Brooks, Clayton Northmont 3-2;

Division II

TEAM SCORES: 1, St. Paris Graham Local 282. 2, Uhrichsville Claymont 81. 3, Hunting Val. Univ. School 80.5. 4, Tol. Central Cath. 47. 5, Oak Harbor 46. 6, Cuy. Falls Walsh Jesuit 43. 7, Orrville 38. 8, Lisbon Beaver 36. 9 (tie), Lexington, Parma Padua Franciscan 34.

(Local)

31 (tie), Keystone 15.

CHAMPIONSHIP FINALS

103: Nick Brascetta, St. Paris Graham Local maj. dec. Andrew Bertubin, Cambridge 13-4;
112: Ty Mitch, Aurora dec. Brandon Gambucci, Lexington 12-7;
119: Johnni DiJulius, Cuy. Falls Walsh Jesuit dec. Drew Stone, Oak Harbor 1-0;
125: Zach Neibert, St. Paris Graham Local dec. Nate Skonieczny, Cuy. Falls Walsh Jesu 8-6;
130: Felipe Martinez, St. Paris Graham Local pin Ryan Nakama, Sunbury Big Walnut 1:14;
135: David Taylor, St. Paris Graham Local pin Manuel Cintron, Alliance 2:39;
140: Harrison Hightower, Hunting Val. Univ. School dec. Matt Stephens, St. Paris Grah 5-2;
145: Brian Stephens, St. Paris Graham Local maj. dec. Mike Fee, Mentor Lake Cath. 14-6;
152: Jonathan McGookey, Sandusky Perkins dec. Huston Evans, St. Paris Graham Local 9-3;
160: Kyle Ryan, St. Paris Graham Local dec. Adam Walters, Chesterland W. Geauga 5-2;
171: Zach Garbrandt, Uhrichsville Claymont dec. Dennis Raber, Orrville 4-3;
189: Max Thomusseit, St. Paris Graham Local dec. Nick Mills, Hunting Val. Univ. Schoo 4-1;
215: Tyler Houska, Medina Highland dec. Dave Pickerel, Tol. Central Cath. 3-2ott;
285: Josh Jackson, Uhrichsville Claymont dec. Ian Jones, Painesville Harvey 5-4.

THIRD-PLACE FINALS

103: Luke Langdon, Uhrichsville Claymont dec. Brian Spangler, LaGrange Keystone 11-4;

CONSOLATION SEMIFINALS

103: Luke Langdon, Uhrichsville Claymont dec. Cory Stainbrook, Streetsboro 6-4; Brian Spangler, LaGrange Keystone dec. John McComas, Lisbon Beaver 5-0;
152: Shane Gifford, Circleville Logan Elm dec. Michael Graves, Maumee 7-1; Brad Wukie, Hunting Val. Univ. School (Elyria) pin Rob Eddy, Cadiz Harrison Central 4:46.

Division III

TEAM SCORES: 1, Troy Christian 113. 2, Monroeville 112. 3, Cuy. Val. Chr. Acad. 103. 4, Marion Pleasant 60.5. 5, Mechanicsburg 54. 6, Bloomdale Elmwood 46. 7, Bellaire 41. 8, N. Jackson Jackson-Milton 40.5. 9, Massillon Tuslaw 37. 10, Apple Creek Waynedale 34.

(Local)

21 (tie), Oberlin 20. 67 (tie), Wellington 5.

CHAMPIONSHIP FINALS

103: Nick Goebel, Bloomdale Elmwood dec. Alex Dronzek, Beachwood 3-2;
112: Bryce Baker, Mechanicsburg dec. Spencer Pierce, Richwood N. Union 6-3;
119: Hunter Stieber, Monroeville pin Tyler Heminger, Galion Northmor 1:42;
125: Logan Stieber, Monroeville tech. fall Alex Lopez, Hamler Patrick Henry 16-1;
130: Cam Tessari, Monroeville maj. dec. Erik Canter, Bellaire 13-0;
135: Tyler Powers, Cuy. Val. Chr. Acad. dec. Ben Kuzma, Bascom Hopewell-Loudon 7-1;
140: Zac Hancock, Troy Christian dec. Zach Noernberg, Cle. Cuyahoga Hts. 13-7;
145: Chris Burns, Troy Christian dec. Alex Betts, Bloomdale Elmwood 2-1;
152: Jake Howe, Blanchester maj. dec. Kyle Burns, Troy Christian 14-4;
160: Zach Toal, Troy Christian maj. dec. Alex Utley, Cuy. Val. Chr. Acad. 15-5;
171: Chris Phillips, Monroeville pin Jonathan Beam, Apple Creek Waynedale 2:28;
189: Corby Running, Clarksville Clinton-Massie dec. Colton Bowers, Marion Pleasant 5-3sv;
215: Stuart Miller, Delphos Jefferson dec. Ethan Hayes, New Lebanon Dixie 7-1;
285: Nick Hamilton, Greenwich S. Central dec. Josh Morosko, Massillon Tuslaw 7-4.

THIRD-PLACE FINALS

285: Hugh Thornton, Oberlin dec. Mike Treon, Versailles 7-1.

SEVENTH-PLACE FINALS

160: Matt Ramage, Wellington dec. Jake Elling, Liberty Center 10-5;

CONSOLATION SEMIFINALS

285: Mike Treon, Versailles dec. Chris Doughty, Norwalk St. Paul 3-0; Hugh Thornton, Oberlin over Tyler Obringer, Spencerville default.

DAVID RICHARD / CHRONICLE

Oberlin senior heavyweight Hugh Thornton celebrates after winning his match for third place Saturday.

Pioneer seniors go out in style

Shaun Bennett
The Chronicle-Telegram

COLUMBUS — Elyria wrapped up one of its best seasons in three decades Saturday morning as four Pioneers seniors came away with Division I state placements.

Dalton McHenry kicked things off with a 13-6 decision over Massillon Perry's Zach Dailey to finish third at 130 pounds, Phillip Egnor was pinned by Hilliard Darby's Joe Crabtree to take sixth at 152 pounds, Zack Goins finished fifth at 160 after Marysville's Caleb Marsh defaulted to him and Ryan Nelisse finished sixth after defaulting to Centerville's Kyle Rose.

"We're going to miss those guys for sure," Pioneers coach Erik Burnett said. "But it's not just their wrestling we're going to miss, it's everything about them."

The Pioneers had their best season under Burnett, who took over the program in 1997. They earned their first trip to the Division I state duals, competed in top-level tournaments such as the Walsh Jesuit Ironman and Brecksville Holiday tournament, advanced half their lineup to the Mentor district tournament and put six through to Columbus.

The strong run by the group at state gave Elyria a sixth-place finish — the Pioneers were tied with Mayfield — the best finish under Burnett's direction and the best since Elyria won the state championship in 1973.

"That's really been on our minds the last couple of days," Nelisse said. "We came in here and we wanted to set the bar high. We wanted to have one of the best team finishes in school history."

McHenry earned a pin in his consolation semifinal, and called the matches he wrestled Saturday the best he's had in Columbus.

"I just told myself that these were the last two matches of my high school career," McHenry said. "I knew after my loss on Friday that the state championship wasn't in the picture anymore. So it felt good to go out there and finish the best that I possibly could."

Nelisse revealed that he had torn his labrum during the Ironman tournament, which takes place on the opening weekend of the season, and the shoulder injury flared up during a match Friday. He tried to wrestle through the pain during a consolation semifinal loss, but couldn't go during his placement match.

"I feel good about placing, but I really thought I could do better," Nelisse said. "I'm pretty disappointed with the whole weekend. Injuries really slowed me down."

While Goins also seemed disappointed with his final result, he seemed a little shaken that his high school career had come to an end.

"It's overwhelming knowing that it's all over," Goins said. "I really can't believe it. I'm glad I got a win in my final match. I got to look out at my family and my parents, and give them my thanks."

While Elyria will be losing some talented seniors, some believe they'll come back just as strong next season.

"We still have a lot of young guys on our team," said Egnor, whose brother Kodie will be a senior next season. "I know they'll work hard during the offseason and put in the work. I'm sure we'll see plenty of them down here next year."

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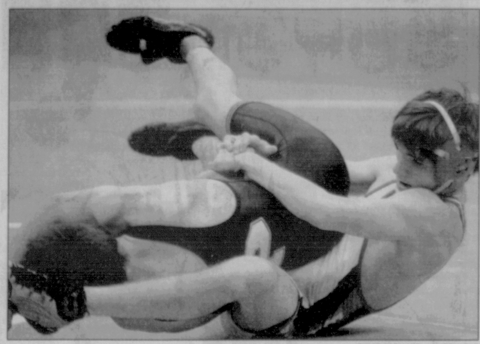


DAVID RICHARD / CHRONICLE

Elyria's Dalton McHenry, right, defeats Massillon Perry's Zach Dailey 13-6 Saturday to take third place at 130 pounds. The Pioneers finished sixth in the team standings.

NOTES

Staying hungry

Lawrence motivated by another close loss

Shaun Bennett
The Chronicle-Telegram

COLUMBUS — Westlake junior Nick Lawrence knows what it's like to lose a Division I state championship match by one point.

Lawrence suffered a 1-0 decision to Solon's Garrett Henry in the 119-pound final a year ago, then lost 3-2 Saturday night to Massillon Perry senior Sam White — who won a state title as a sophomore and was runner-up last season — in the 125-pound title match.

Lawrence is Westlake's first three-time state placer and the first Demons wrestler to reach back-to-back championship matches. Lawrence and White traded escape points in the second and third periods before White shot in for a takedown to get the win.

"That match was exciting," Demons coach Mike Antonyzyn said. "We were all on the edge of our seats."

"He's really good at hand fighting," Lawrence said. "Plus I usually shoot in on the right leg and that was the leg he kept away from me during the match."

The pair met two years ago in the semifinals in Columbus, a match White won by an 11-2 major decision.

"He's a little bit bigger now," White said of Lawrence. "And a lot better."

Lawrence said last season's one-point loss made him hungry to get working toward this year and another shot at a state title. So does a second one-point loss make him more hungry?

"About twice as much," Lawrence said.

Freshman phenom

Keystone's Brian Spangler wrapped up a stellar freshman season with a fourth-place finish at 103 pounds in Division II. The finish was the best by a freshman at a Lorain County school since Oberlin's Erik Burnett won the 98-pound state championship in 1984.

"I'm happy that I finished in fourth place because a lot of freshmen don't even make it to state," said Spangler, who has trained with Burnett at the Barn in LaGrange. "I'm glad I was able to set some school records this season, too."

Spangler became the first Keystone freshman to win a district championship, and just the school's third overall, and was the youngest wrestler to earn a state placement.

"I'm going to start training for next season," Spangler said. "I never take a break. It seems like I'm always at practice."

Other notable freshman placers from Lorain County schools include Elyria Catholic's Scott Burnett (fifth in 1995), Elyria's Steve Mitcheff (seventh in 2005) and Southview's Narcisco Inchaurregui (seventh in 2008).

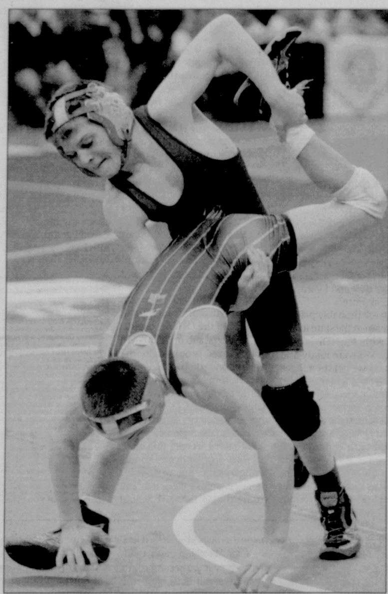
Phoenix rises

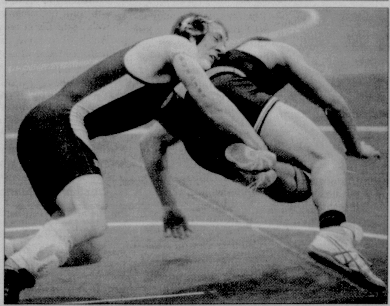
Oberlin heavyweight Hugh Thornton bounced all the way back from a quarterfinal loss to take third place in Division III. Thornton's placement is the highest for the Oberlin wrestling program since Burnett captured a state championship his senior year in 1987.

"I think I'm going to retire these wrestling shoes," said Thornton, who will play football for Illinois next year.

Thornton qualified to the Idaho state tournament as a sophomore and captured a Class 5A (big school) state title last season.

"The wrestling's a lot tougher here," Thornton said. "These guys aren't just big, they're big and good."





DAVID RICHARD / CHRONICLE PHOTOS

Keystone's Brian Spangler, top photo, took fourth, the best finish by a freshman from a Lorain County school in 25 years. In the bottom photo, Wellington's Matt Ramage, left, won his final match to take seventh.

Eagle's vengeance

St. Edward junior Anthony Salupo, a Westlake resident and the projected Division I 135-pound champion, was denied his title when Uniontown Lake's Scott Mattingly scored five points in the final minute of their quarterfinal match to score a 6-5 win.

Salupo got his revenge Saturday morning with a 4-2 win over Mattingly to finish third.

"I felt I had him beat the first time so I knew I could beat him again," said Salupo, who is 2-3 all time against Mattingly. "I was crushed after that loss. Now I have to wait another year, but I'm confident I'll take it all next year."

Good way to finish

Wellington senior Matt Ramage became the program's first state placer since Joe Bockmore finished fourth in 2005, and did it with a 10-5 decision over Liberty Center's Jake Elling in the seventh-place match.

"He finished with a win, and that's big," Dukes coach John Sedlick said. "It's nice to be able to go home on a winning note."

Takedowns

For the second straight season, University School junior Brad Wukie didn't get to wrestle in his final match in Division II. After suffering a double elbow injury as a sophomore and defaulting to sixth place, Wukie injured his knee during his consolation semifinal win Saturday morning and defaulted in his next match to finish fourth.

Wukie, an Elyria resident, has yet to win his final match at state, losing in the championship match as a freshman.

- Olmsted Falls senior Zach Laird continued the Bulldogs' recent run of state placers. The heavyweight lost both matches Saturday, but still finished sixth. He joins Jerry Knapp (eighth in 2008), Aaron Schecter (third, 2007) and Zach McGrain (fifth, 2006) as recent Bulldog placers.

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MAT MATTERS

Match of the day

St. Edward senior Collin Palmer became the 18th four-time state champion in Ohio history with a 3-1 victory over Reynoldsburg senior Tommy Sasfy in the 140-pound final. Palmer was hit with a stalling point in the second period, but a first-period takedown and a third-period escape gave him the victory.

Upset of the day

It wasn't an upset of epic proportions, but Wellington senior Matt Ramage — ranked No. 23 in the state — continued his strong Division III state tournament with a convincing 10-5 win over Liberty Center's Jake Elling — ranked No. 18 in the state — in the 160-pound seventh-place match.

Lookahead

Many of the area state qualifiers will be in action one last time at the Lorain County Wrestling All-Star meet Thursday at Vermilion High School. The event will take place at 6 p.m., and will feature the top six wrestlers at each weight class, the county's Hall of Fame inductees and the announcement of the county's wrestler of the year.

— Shaun Bennett

PALMER

From C1

was pressure enough."

Palmer attacked from the opening whistle and scored a quick takedown on Reynoldsburg senior Tommy Sasfy. Palmer squeezed tight and stuck his boots into the sides of Sasfy, but was unable to turn Sasfy for a nearfall. He did manage to ride out Sasfy for the rest of the period to maintain a 2-0 lead.

Sasfy chose the down position to open the second period, but again couldn't escape Palmer's vise-like grip. Sasfy did manage to earn a point during the period, when Palmer was called for stalling after hanging onto Sasfy's leg with just a few seconds left.

Palmer opened the final period with a quick escape, then had to fight off a shot by Sasfy midway through the period to come away with the 3-1 decision.

"I wasn't too worried about (the shot) because I love to scramble," Palmer said. "I was hoping to get that last two (points) at the end, but I'm just glad I finished it off.

"That last whistle was a huge relief."

As the match ended, Palmer rose to his feet and the Schottenstein Center crowd did the same. He raised four fingers in the air as the referee raised his hand to a lengthy standing ovation.

"That was unbelievable," Palmer said of the applause. "It just goes right through you."

Palmer quickly ran over to hug his coaches, then ran into the crowd to celebrate with his family, starting with a huge bear hug for his father, Dwayne.

"He's the one who got me here," Palmer said.

He then added, "What am I? The 17th? The 18th?"

Palmer had to ask what number he was to win four titles, because one weight class before St. Paris Graham's David Taylor became the 17th.

Palmer said he still had to make a call to Lance, who is with Ohio State at the Big Ten Championships in State College, Pa. Collin will join Lance next year as a freshman for the Buckeyes.

But for now, Collin will be looking to enjoy a much-needed rest.

"My body's really beat up," he said. "I'm ready for a break."

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